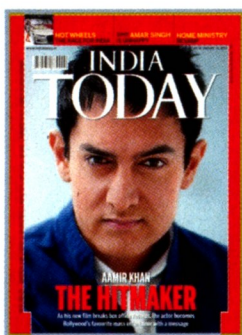


Aamir Khan: The Hitmaker

JANUARY 18, 2010

As his new film breaks box office records, the actor becomes Bollywood's favourite mass entertainer with a message.



“Unlike other actors, Aamir Khan has put a premium on quality over quantity. One of the hallmarks of his career is the fact that very rarely has he repeated himself in the same genre in consecutive films.”

AMBAR MALLICK, *Kolkata*

Role Call

Aamir Khan has come out as an extremely intelligent, humane, competent, unassuming aesthete (“Aamir Khan: The Hitmaker”, January 18). He is seemingly a torch-bearer of middle class values and this persona of his perhaps would never have developed had he not very deftly kept himself insulated from the known adverse external influences of Bollywood. It is apparent that he never chased money. It is also apparent that he does not seem to be apologetic about his obvious intellect and capability and has been using it in his work in good measure.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *Mumbai*

Aamir's USP is his disarming simplicity combined with plain speaking. He



Home Truth

Since terrorism has become a big problem, India should have a separate ministry at the Centre called the Ministry of Anti-Terrorism (“A Super Ministry of Security”, January 18). This ministry should focus only on counter-terrorism efforts. It should also ensure that due action is taken against those involved in it, be it individuals, groups or countries.

M. KUMAR, *via www.indiatoday.in*

P. Chidambaram has rightly concluded that the current Home Ministry is not only unduly overburdened with issues that have little relevance to internal security but is also being plagued by wasteful duplication of work. It is laudable that the UPA Government is giving the home minister a free hand in revamping the ministry.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*

once exclaimed that a man's requirement for money has its limits and a person cannot eat more than three square meals a day notwithstanding the power and pelf he must be having. He also put to practice what he said then by not indiscriminately accepting a large number of projects while ensuring that he chose good roles where he could do his best.

BICHU MUTTATHARA, *Pune*

Wheels and Deals

Big cars, defined according to ex-factory price, should be taxed at 100 per cent excise duty to discourage their production and use (“Rush Hour”, January 18). This will not only curb fuel consumption but will also help car manufacturers concentrate on the production of

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